

Task 6

Gophish Simulated Phishing Campaign Report

Gophish

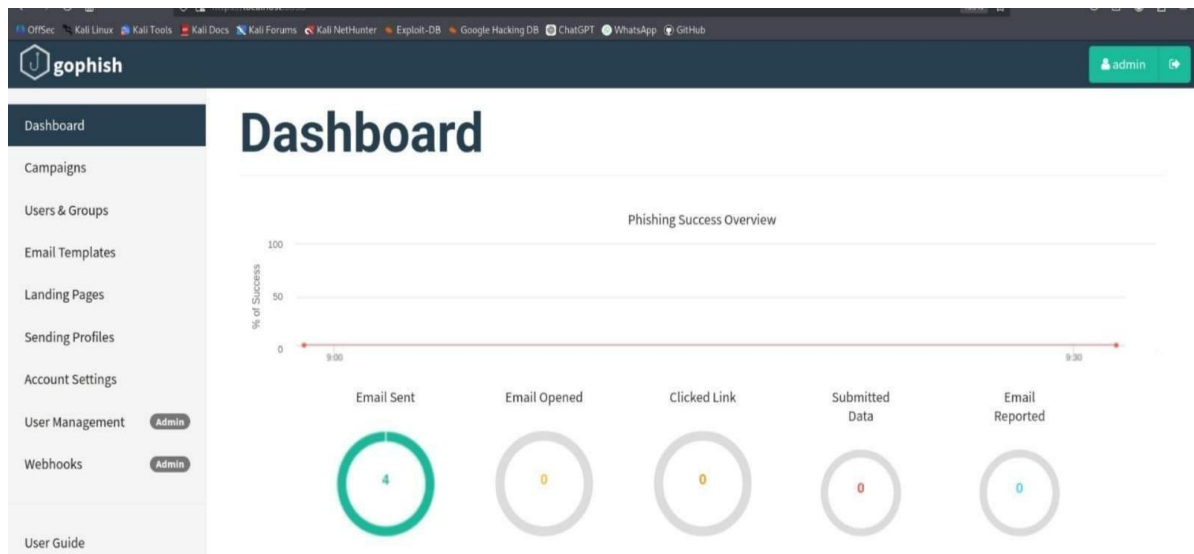
Gophish is an open-source phishing simulation toolkit designed for security professionals to test and improve an organization's awareness of phishing attacks. It allows users to create and send realistic phishing emails, set up fake landing pages, and track how recipients interact — including who opens, clicks, or submits information.

Executive Summary

This report details a controlled, simulated phishing campaign executed using the open-source **Gophish** framework inside a Kali Linux virtual machine. The exercise was performed in a safe, isolated environment with the explicit goal of assessing user susceptibility to social-engineering attacks, validating the organisation's detection and response controls, and producing actionable recommendations to reduce human risk. All steps — from scoping and template design to delivery, tracking, and analysis — were documented and supported with screenshots captured from the Gophish dashboard and the target VM.

Setup and Dashboard

Gophish was accessed through its web-based dashboard on Kali Linux. The dashboard provides an overview of campaigns, including email statistics such as sent, opened, clicked, submitted, and report



User Groups created

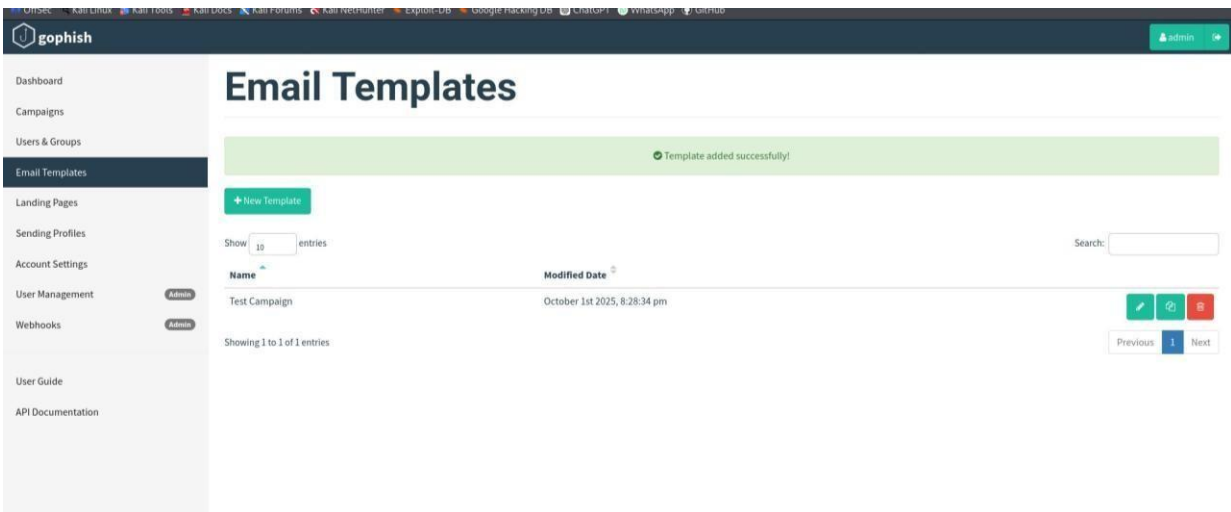
In the **Users & Groups** section we created a test group made up of test accounts that acted as targets for the phishing campaign.

The screenshot shows the Gophish 'Users & Groups' page. At the top, a green banner displays the message 'Group added successfully!'. Below this is a 'New Group' button. A search bar is located on the right. The main content is a table with the following columns: Name, # of Members, and Modified Date. The table contains one entry named 'testgroup' with 1 member, last modified on October 1st 2025 at 8:22:24 pm. At the bottom right, there are 'Previous' and 'Next' navigation buttons, with '1' indicating the current page.

Name	# of Members	Modified Date
testgroup	1	October 1st 2025, 8:22:24 pm

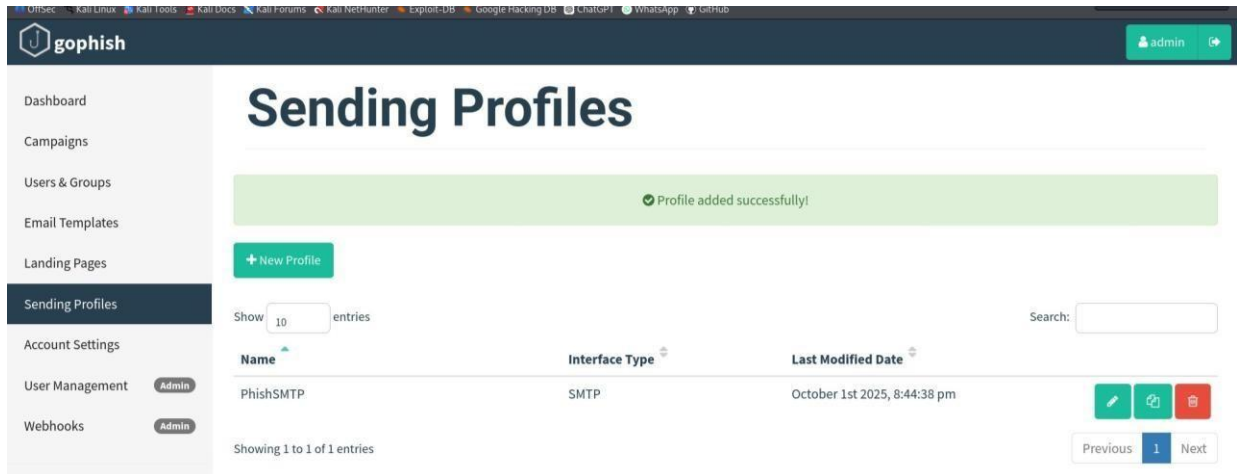
Email Template Creation

A phishing **email template** was designed in the “Email Templates” section. The email was made to look urgent and professional, tricking users into clicking a **malicious link**.



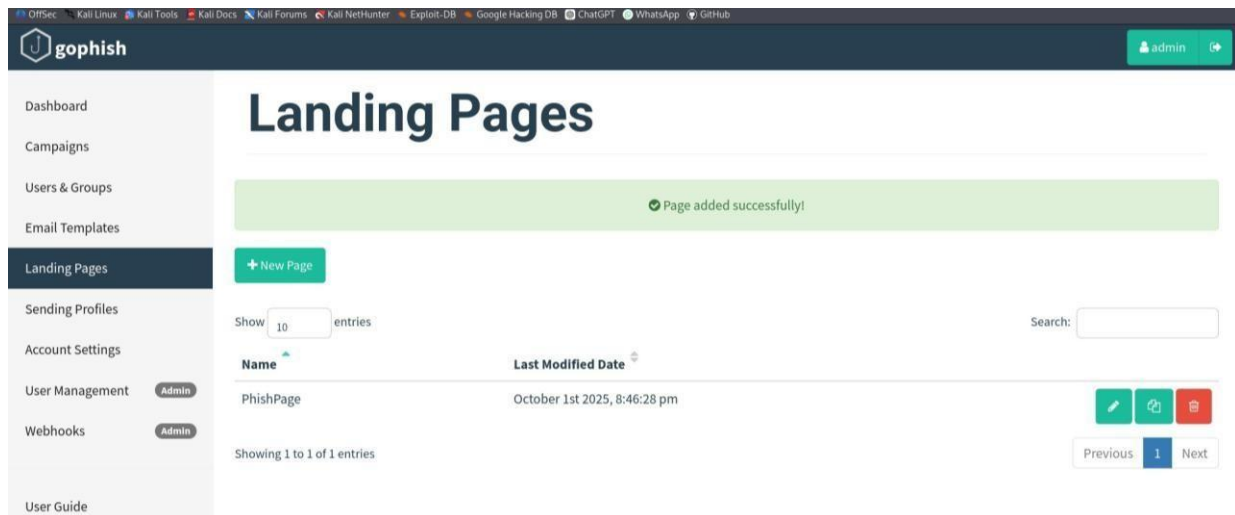
Sending Profile Configuration

A **sending profile** was set up with SMTP details so that the phishing emails appeared to come from a legitimate account. This helped make the attack more convincing.



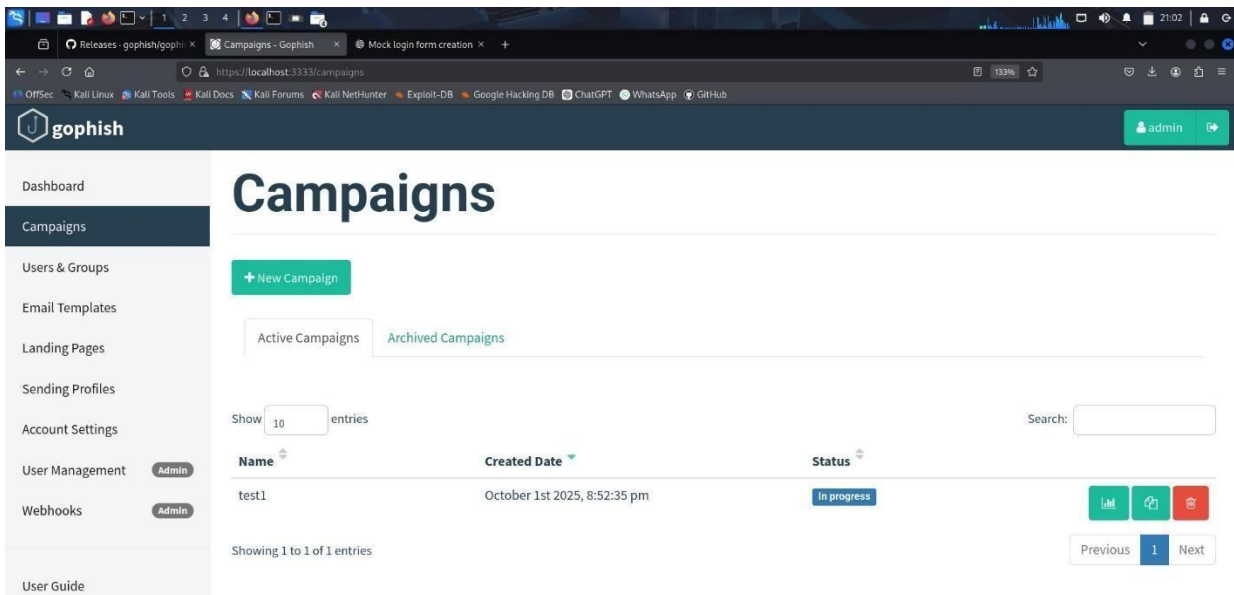
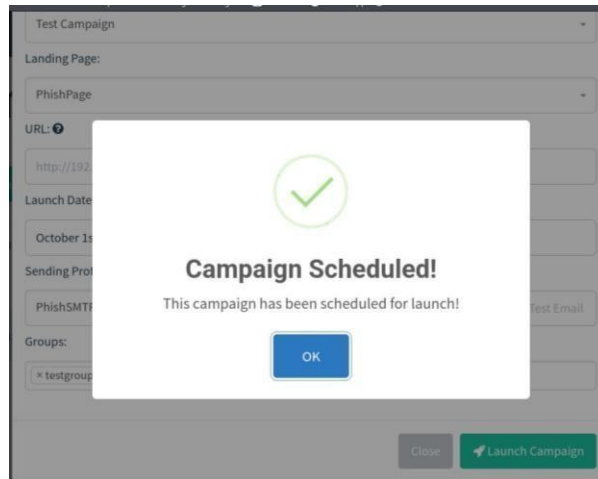
Landing Page Design

A custom **landing page** was created for harvesting credentials. If a target clicked the phishing link, they were redirected to this page and prompted to submit sensitive information.



Campaign Creation and Execution

A phishing campaign was launched using the configured group, template, sending profile, and landing page. The campaign ran successfully and allowed live tracking of user interactions.



Conclusion

The Gophish simulation demonstrated the full lifecycle of a phishing attack, from creating groups, templates, and landing pages to tracking user interactions. It highlighted both technical and human vulnerabilities, showing how certain users are more likely to engage with phishing emails. The exercise reinforced the importance of regular awareness training, robust email controls, and secure processes for testing. Overall, it provided actionable insights to strengthen organizational defenses against phishing threats.

Submitted by:
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